

Unit 7 Heavy Weather

Read & Listen

Exercise 1

The Marina **1. is underway** in the Bay of Biscay. It is about seven AM on Sunday morning and John Andersen is standing the four to eight **2. watch**. The weather forecast the previous evening had told of **3. low pressures** forming in the western Atlantic and had given **4. a gale** warning. **5. The sea is rough** – the wind is increasing by the hour. The **6. barometer 7. has dropped** and the air is white with **8. spray**.

Captain James has been through many storms. He knows that he will need all his **9. skill** and experience to save the ship from damage or loss. There are many important **10. factors to consider** - the **11. wind direction and force**, **12. the course** being steered and **13. the height of the sea**. In a strong **14. headwind** the vessel will **15. pitch**, when the **16. wind is abeam the ship**, we say that she is **17. rolling**.

1. is proceeding on a voyage
2. working hours at sea
3. condition in the atmosphere in bad weather
4. wind force 8 on the Beaufort scale
5. the waves are high
6. an instrument for measuring air pressure
7. has fallen
8. drops of liquid blown through the air
9. ability to do something well
10. things to think about
11. from where it blows and how strong it is
12. the direction a ship is taking
13. how high the waves are
14. wind on the ship's bow
15. the ship's movement in a headwind
16. wind on the ship's side
17. the ship's movement in a sidewind

Exercise 2

When the Marina was loaded, the Chief Mate was careful to see that the loading did not decrease **1. the stability** of the Marina. If much of the cargo weight is at the bottom of the holds, the centre of gravity is low; we say that the **2. ship is stiff**. The **3. breaking waves** then **4. strike** the ship's hull with force and in some cases the hull might even be damaged. If too much cargo has been placed in the 'tween decks or on the decks the **5. ship is tender**, and she will roll freely and rapidly. Cargo might **6. shift** and the ship might start **7. to list**. She may then be **8. unable** to **9. recover** from a roll and may **10. capsize**.

1. how well a ship endures the wind
2. ship moving heavily in the wind
3. big waves with white crests
4. hit
5. ship rolling freely in the wind
6. move from one place to another
7. to heel over in the wind
8. cannot do
9. come back to normal
10. turn over completely in the wind

Exercise 3

Both wind and sea are now **<abaft the starboard beam>** of the Marina, which is rolling heavily in the high seas.

Captain: I think we ought to **<reduce speed>** to **<half speed>**.

Chief Officer: OK, **<Half speed>**.

Captain James has reduced speed to save the Marina from being hit too violently by the waves. The storm is now becoming increasingly violent and the Marina **<is pounding>** heavily.

Captain: We shall have to heave to. We'll take **<her bow to the sea>**. **<Hand steering on>!**

Chief Officer: Very well, hand steering!

Captain: <**Stand by Engine Room control**>!

Engine Room Control: <**Standing By**>.

Exercise 4

1. The waves are often called <**seas**>.
2. When there is <**low pressure**>, we can expect wind and rain.
3. The gripes used for lowering a life boat are called <**davits**>.
4. When the wind is on the bow it is called <**headwind**>.
5. When the waves have <**crests**> the air fills with spray.
6. When there is bad weather the barometer <**drops**>.
7. In a storm we must fasten or <**secure/tighten**> loose gear on deck.
8. What are the ship's movements called?
 - in a headwind <**pitching**>.
 - when the wind is on the beam <**rolling**>.
9. Wind Force 10 on the Beaufort scale means <**storm**>.
10. How stable a vessel is in the wind and seas is called its <**stability**>.
11. When a ship heels over in the wind we say that she <**lists**>.
12. The vessel had a list or <**tilt**> of 10 degrees to port.
13. When a ship turns over completely in the wind we say that she <**capsizes**>.
14. Captain James decided to take the bow to the wind - that is, to <**heave to**>.
15. When the Captain wanted the Engine Room to be ready he said <**Stand by Engine Room Control**>!
16. When he wanted to steer the ship manually he gave the order <**Hand steering on**>!
17. When the waves are very high we say that the sea is <**rough**>.
18. Waves with white crests are called <**breaking waves**>.
19. The white crests sometimes fill the air with <**spray**>.
20. When cargo moves because of the ship's roll we say that the cargo <**shifts**>.
21. When the centre of gravity on a ship is high we say that she is <**tender**> and when the centre of gravity is low we say she is <**stiff**>.
22. If a ship cannot <**recover**> from a roll she will capsize.

Exercise 5

1. Tighten the boat gripes!
<**I have tightened**> the boat gripes.
2. Clear away all loose gear!
<**I have cleared**> away all loose gear.
3. Cast off from the bollards !
<**I have cast off**> from the bollards.
4. Single up aft!
<**I have singled up**> aft.
5. Check the lashings!
<**I have checked**> the lashings.
6. Tell the crew!
<**I have told**> the crew.